Read a Picture Graph to 5

Parent guide

Try one activity for 5-10 minutes.

Your child should be able to count up to 5.

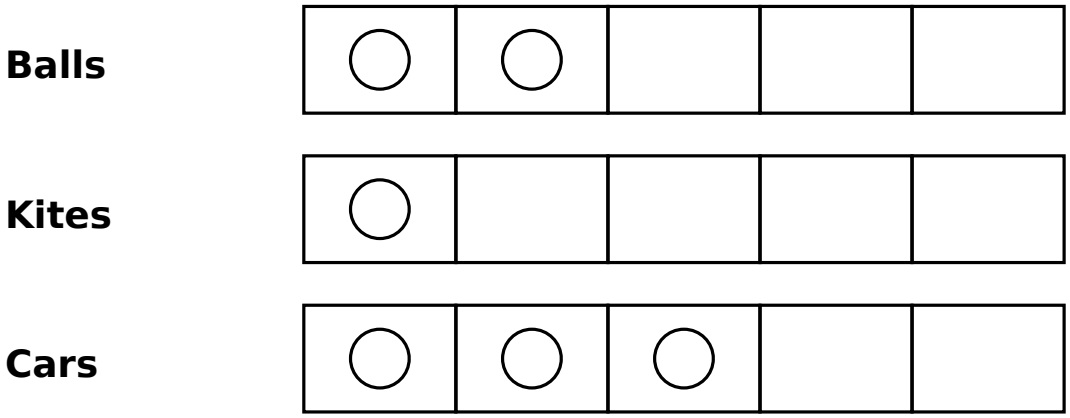
Read labels and questions aloud. Spoken answers are welcome.

You need a pencil. No cutting or extra materials are needed.

Model it together: toys on a shelf

A circle stands for one toy. The labels tell the kind of toy.

Count circles, not boxes. All circles have the same value.



◯ **= 1 toy. Empty boxes do not count.**

There are 2 balls, 1 kite and 3 cars.

Cars are the largest group: they have the most circles.

Kites are the smallest group: they have the fewest circles.

Point to each circle once. Compare how many circles each row has.

These are made-up toy collections, not a survey to fill in.

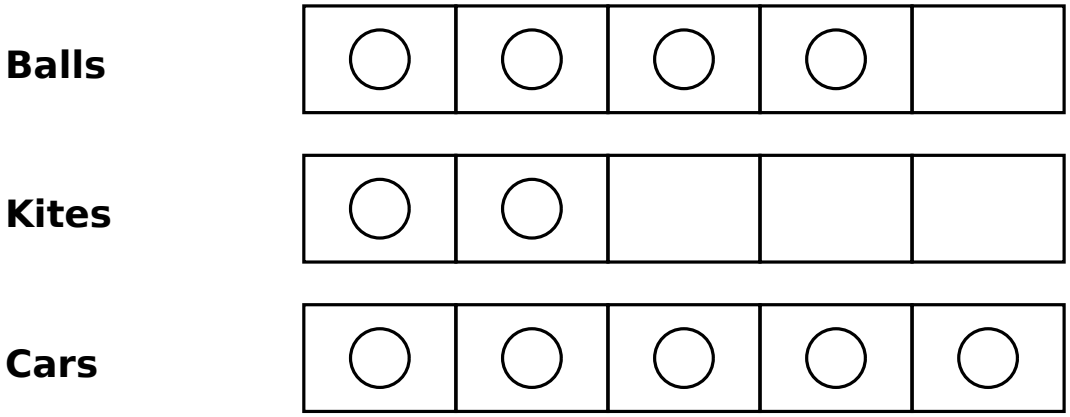
Print pages 2-3 on A4. Black-and-white printing is suitable.

Answers and a completed graph are on page 4.

1. Read the toy graph

Count the circles in each row. Each circle stands for one toy.

Write or say your answers. Empty boxes do not count.



◯ **= 1 toy. Empty boxes do not count.**

How many?

1. Balls: _____ Kites: _____ Cars: _____
2. Which kind of toy has the most? _____
3. Which kind of toy has the fewest? _____

Compare and explain

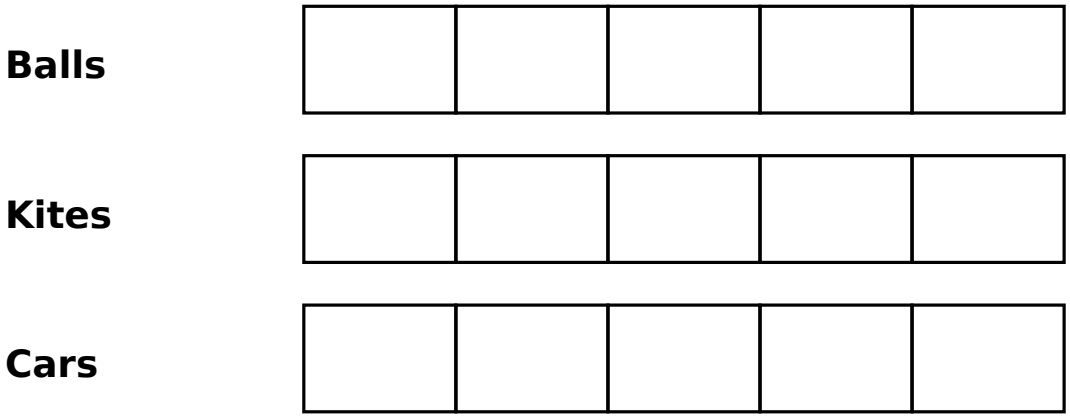
4. How many more cars than balls are there? _____
5. How can the graph help you find the largest group?

2. Complete a toy graph

A different toy shelf has: 3 balls, 3 kites and 1 car.

Draw one circle for each toy. Start in the left-hand box.

Put one circle in each box you use. Leave other boxes empty.



◯ **= 1 toy. Empty boxes do not count.**

Read your finished graph

1. Which two kinds have the same number? _____
2. Which kind has the fewest? _____
3. How many kites are there? _____

Check together

Touch each circle once. Do the rows show 3, 3 and 1?

Do both equal groups start at the left and end together?

If drawing is difficult, an adult can draw as the child counts.

Answers and next steps

Page 2: Read the toy graph

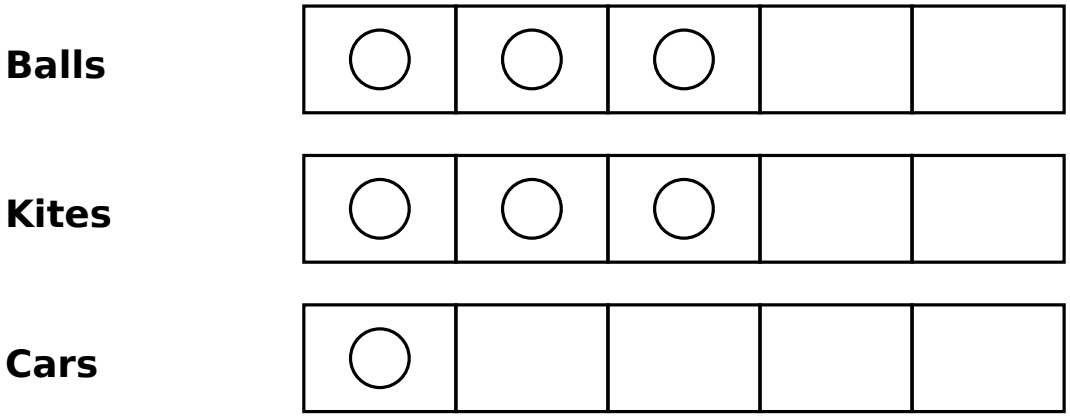
1. Balls = 4; kites = 2; cars = 5.

2. Cars. 3. Kites. 4. One more car: 5 - 4 = 1.

5. Example: the row with the most circles is the largest group.

Other clear explanations are welcome.

Page 3: Completed graph



◯ **= 1 toy. Empty boxes do not count.**

1. Balls and kites. 2. Cars. 3. Three kites.

A short follow-up

Ask your child to explain why balls and kites are equal.

Answer: both rows have 3 circles; each circle means one toy.

Try fewer circles if needed. There is no timed target.

Keep the key the same: one circle always stands for one toy.